

NATURALLY SELECTED

A CONTRARIAN VIEW BY AGENT001

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As usual, I'm going to take the unpopular stance here – but not just because it's unpopular. First things first, since we've gone ahead and associated genetically engineered humans with Hitler, I want to be clear I'm not supporting eugenics. I'm merely saying that we should let the laws of natural selection take their course.

For those who don't know, eugenics is the philosophy of encouraging breeding of people with desirable traits, and suppressing the reproduction, or even sterilising people with perceived negative genetic traits.

An example of this would be encouraging the world's scientists to have more kids, and forbidding hardened criminals from reproducing (perhaps even sterilising them). This is not something any sane person would support. However, before you exhale with a sigh of relief and think that all is well in the world again, you should know that this is in fact happening all the time. A simple example is the economic system the world runs on, which automatically gives kids in developed countries a better chance of not just survival, but also success in life. Poorer countries (third world countries), have more kids, and less success, and high mortality rates.

We may have become more civilised, but the 'survival of the fittest' attitude of the world hasn't yet changed; and I doubt it ever will. Humans are a competitive race, and that's not going to change – not

until a change so drastic happens that today's humans wouldn't consider that future version to be the same species.

EVOLUTION

When we talk about evolution, it's not something "random" or "by chance". Almost all natural selection is by design (not intelligent design, but because of selfish genes). Changes in weather, in surroundings, and even human interference – dogs, for instance, have evolved relatively quickly from wolves to live alongside humans.

Today, humans are living longer and reproducing till later, and that's thanks to the advances in medicine and hygiene. Are we evolving? Yes, of course we are, and we're being naturally selected based on a number of factors, and those factors

depend on where we live, how much we earn, etc. Natural selection is such a complex process, is defined by so many various parameters and is so inevitable, that I dare say it's terribly disingenuous and narcissistic to think that we can ever have any role in opposing it. Mother nature is not a force mere humans can ever hope to totally control – we can't really create or end storms, but merely better our chances of surviving one.

It's in this sense that I'm all for genetics and exploring avenues to better the quality of people's lives. Why should a parent ever suffer helplessly while their child lies in hospital, or a family lose a parent to diabetes or cancer. If genetic engineering can help us create a better us, what's wrong with that? Aren't we essentially doing the same thing already anyway?



India has been declared polio free since 2014 because of some good work done by the government in communicating the need to vaccinate